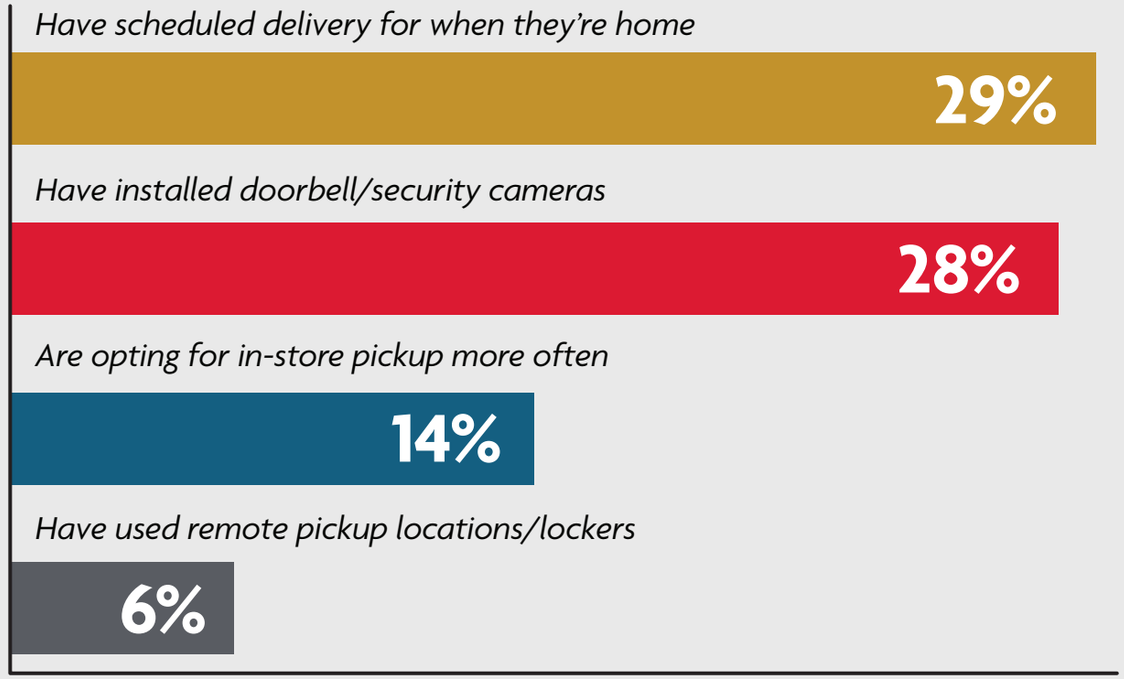
Shoppers seek alternative delivery options to prevent package theft.

Despite **nearly half (48%) of shoppers reporting never having experienced package theft,** they are still taking measures to prevent packages from being stolen from their residences.





Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

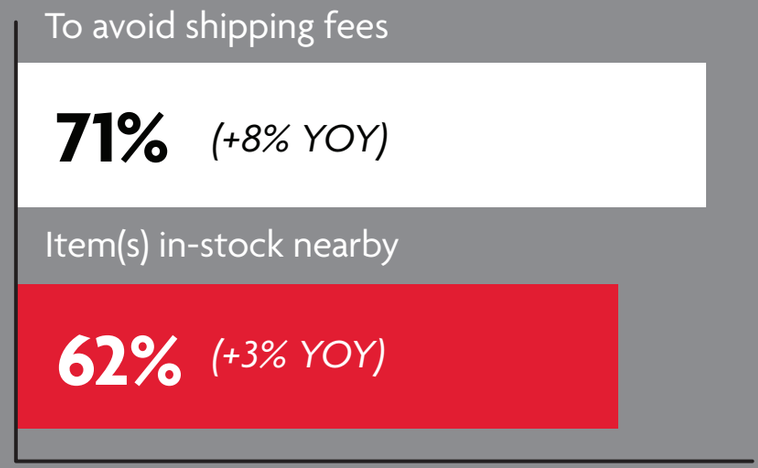
Shipping fees and convenience drive BOPIS activity.

31% of shoppers reported utilizing BOPIS *(+6% YOY)*...

...but fewer customers are making additional purchases when picking up or returning items in-store:

29% *(-11% YOY)*

Most common reasons consumers elect to utilize BOPIS:



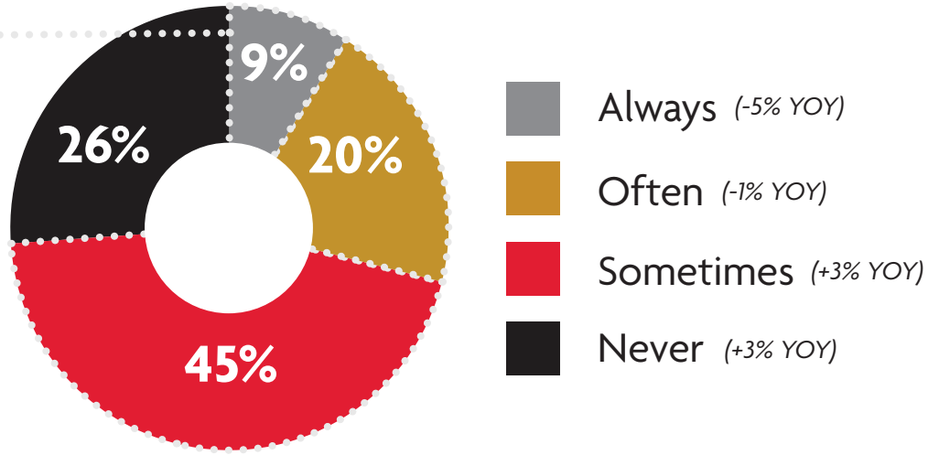
34% of shoppers check for in-store availability before purchasing an item online.

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

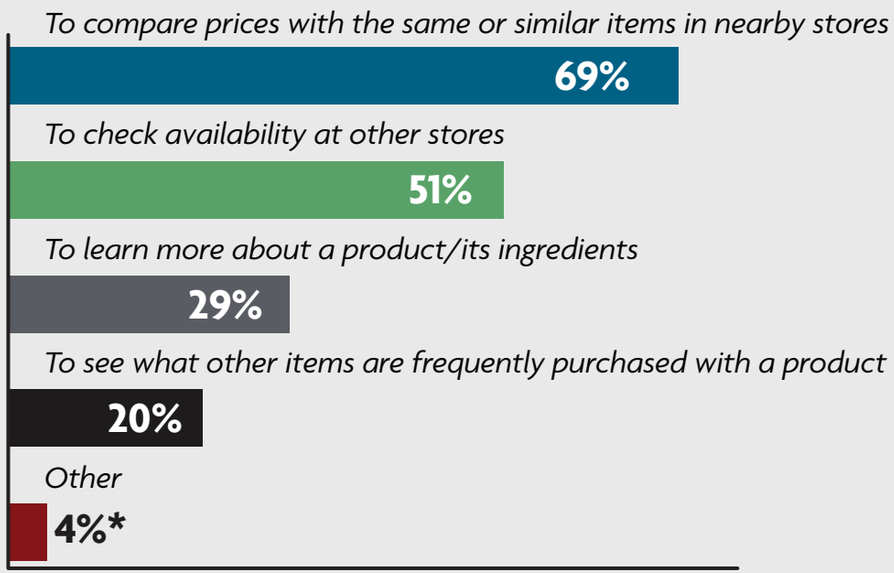
Consumers appear slightly less reliant on mobile devices to aid in-store shopping.



74% of shoppers search for items on their mobile devices while in a store. *(-3% YOY)*



Why do shoppers use their mobile devices while in a store?



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

**Of those who selected "Other," 65% submitted open-ended responses indicating that they use their mobile devices in-store specifically to find the location of an item they are looking for.*

SHIPPING



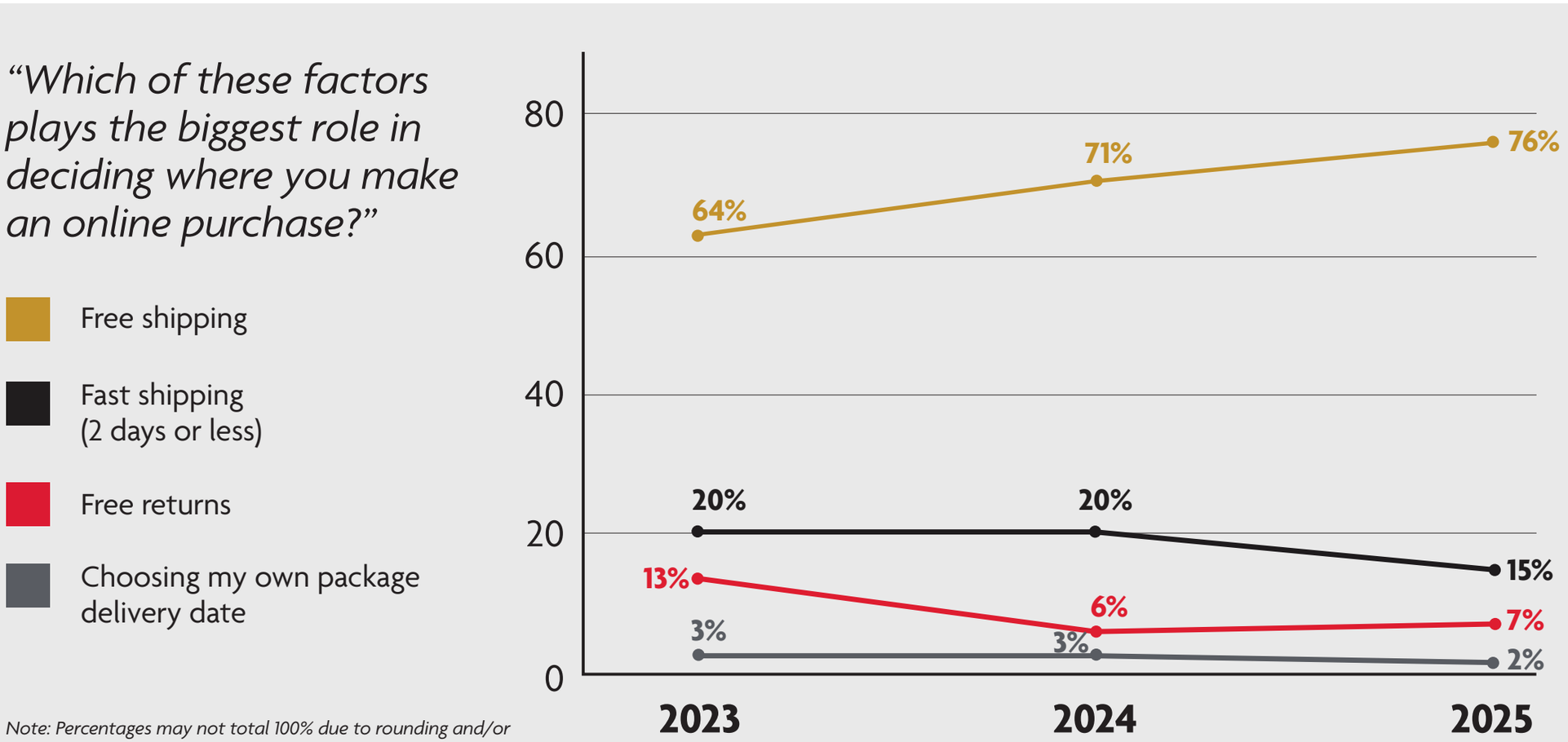
SHIPPING:
KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The influence of free shipping on purchasing decisions is on a steady incline.
- Shoppers' expectations for faster shipping have relaxed.
- Free shipping thresholds continue to contribute to increased average order value.
- Shipping costs are top of mind throughout the buying journey.
- Consumers are decreasingly opposed to paying for shipping that takes longer than 2 days.
- Scheduled delivery is gaining favor when compared to fast shipping.



The influence of free shipping on purchasing decisions is on a steady incline.

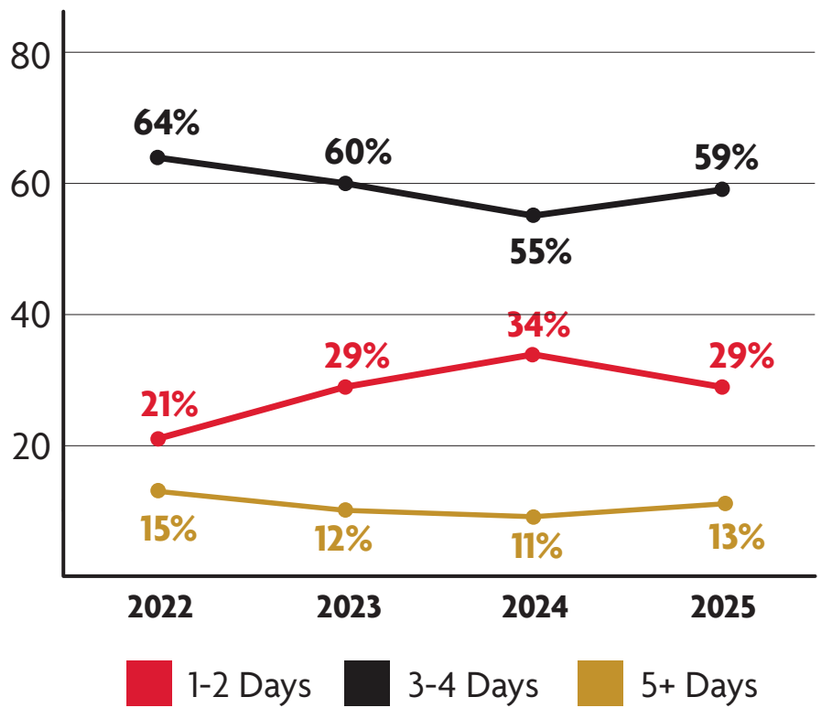
"Which of these factors plays the biggest role in deciding where you make an online purchase?"



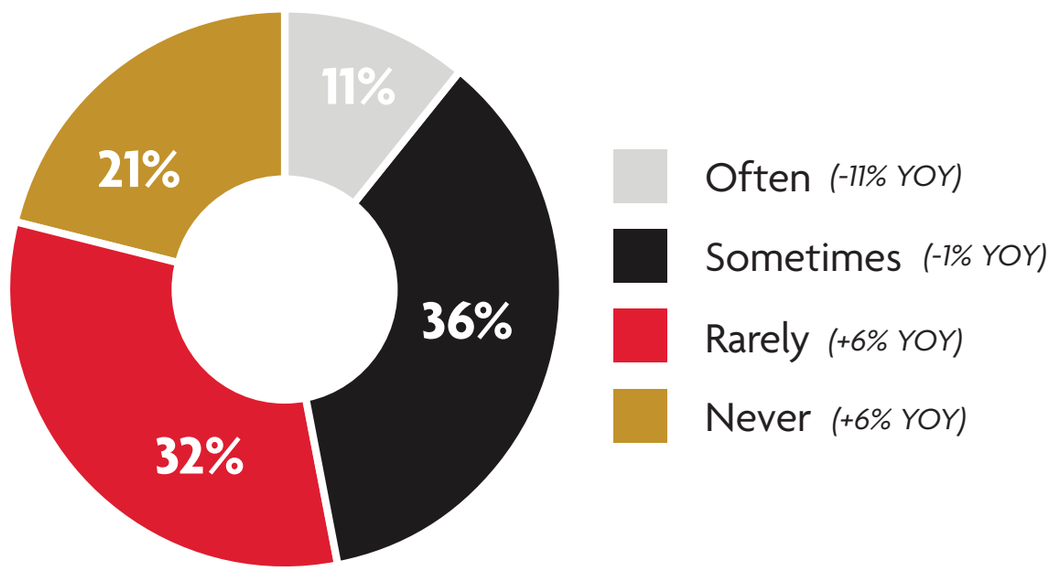
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Shoppers' expectations for faster shipping have relaxed.

Shipping speed expectations:



"How often do you make an online purchase specifically because it's available with same-day delivery?"

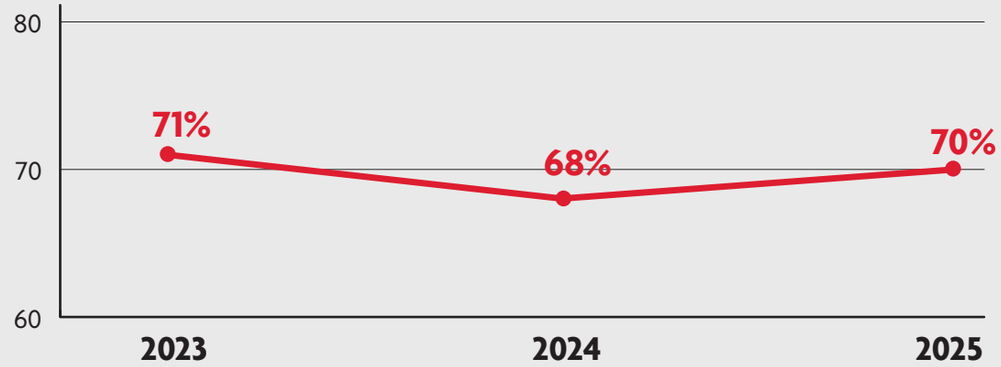


Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Free shipping thresholds continue to contribute to increased average order value.

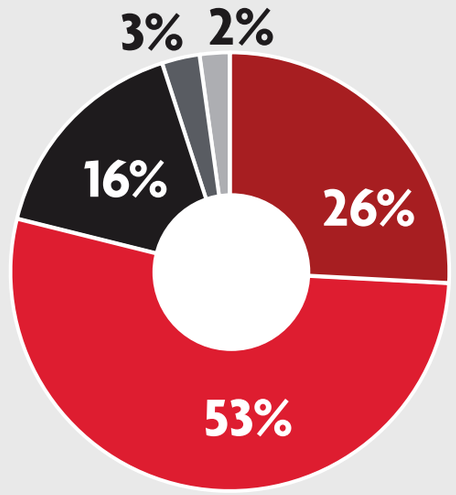


Most consumers have added items to their online shopping carts to qualify for free shipping:



Most shoppers will not spend more than $50 to qualify for free shipping:

- Willing to spend up to $25
- Willing to spend up to $50
- Willing to spend up to $100
- Willing to spend up to $150
- Willing to spend up to $200+



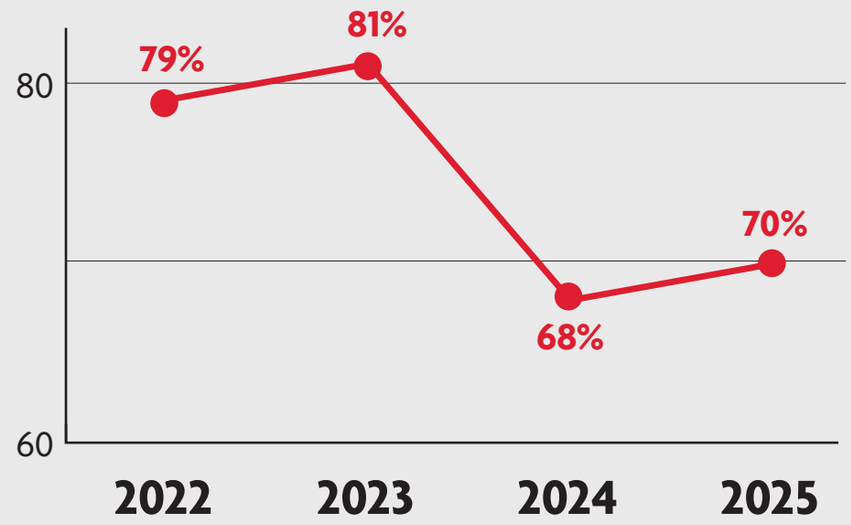
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Shipping costs are top of mind throughout the buying journey.

47%

of shoppers research which sellers offer free or cheaper shipping before buying a product online.

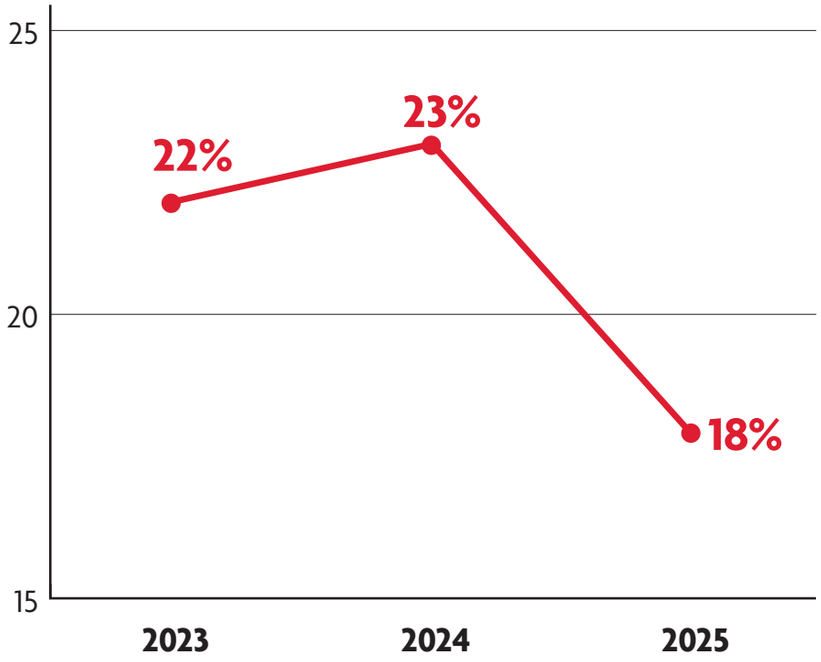
Shoppers who have abandoned items in their online carts upon seeing unanticipated shipping costs:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Consumers are decreasingly opposed to paying for shipping that takes longer than 2 days.

The number of consumers unwilling to pay for shipping that takes longer than 2 days **fell by 5% since 2024.**



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

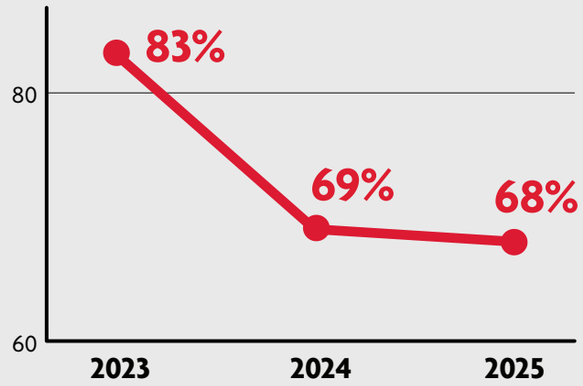


Scheduled delivery is gaining favor when compared to fast shipping.

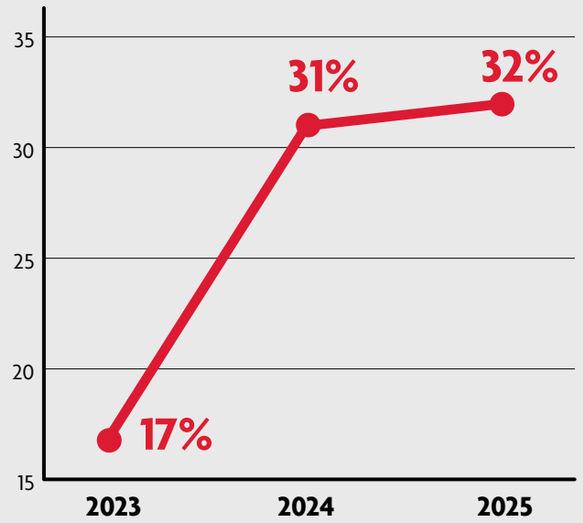
Nearly 1/3
of respondents say scheduled delivery is more important than fast shipping.

"What is more important to you?"

Fast Shipping
(two days or less)



Scheduled Delivery
(receiving your purchase on a specific date)



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

RETURNS



RETURNS:
KEY TAKEAWAYS

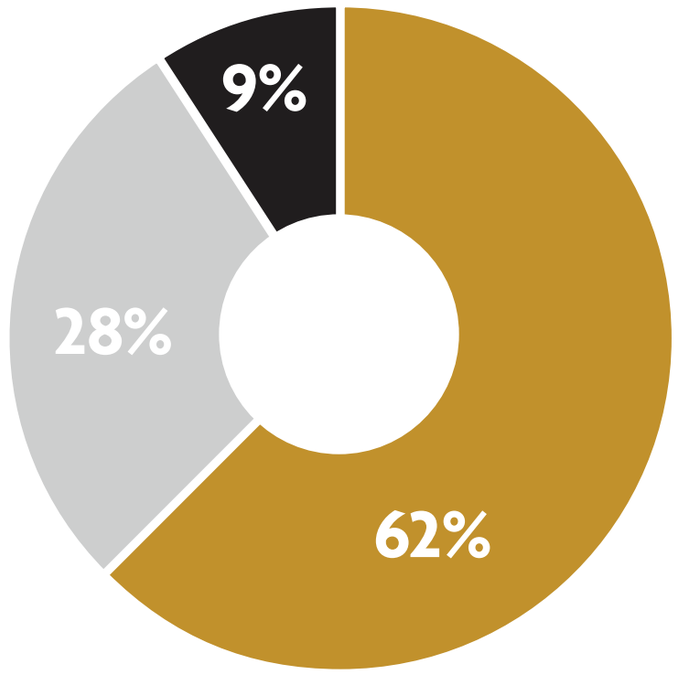
- Regardless of how often they return items, shoppers look for free-return policies.
- Poor fit tops the list of reasons for online returns.
- Returnless refunds increasingly promote brand support and charitable giving.
- Failure to provide hassle-free returns puts customer retention at risk.
- Younger shoppers are more likely to let returns-related hurdles affect future shopping decisions.



Regardless of returns frequency, shoppers look for free-return policies.

In the last year:

- Shoppers that reported returning about the same number of online purchases as usual *(+13% YOY)*
- Shoppers that reported returning fewer online purchases than usual *(-9% YOY)*
- Shoppers that reported returning more online purchases than usual *(-5% YOY)*



57%
of shoppers won't make an online purchase **without a free-return policy.** *(no change)*

40%
of shoppers check if a brand has a **free-return policy before** making an online purchase.

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Poor fit tops the list of reasons for online returns.

Top 3 most returned online purchase categories:

1. Clothing	48%
2. Home Goods	15%
3. Accessories	10%



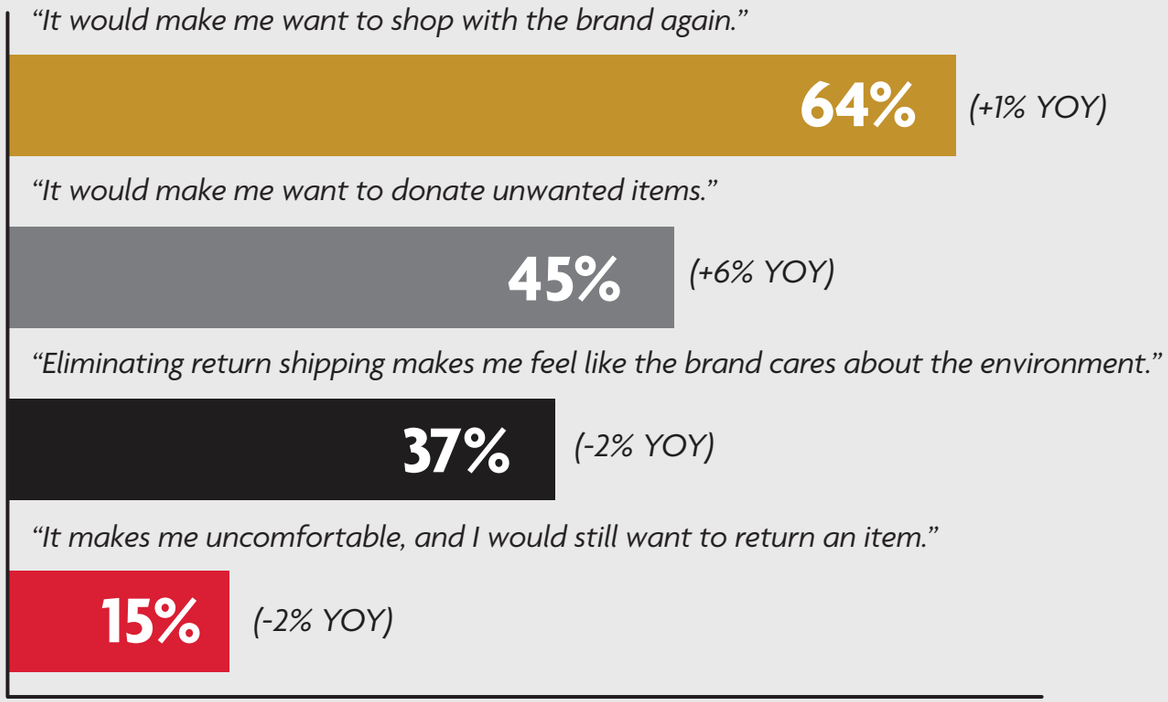
Top 3 reasons for returns:

1. Item(s) did not fit as expected	66%
2. Item(s) were lower quality than expected	28%
3. Items were damaged or defective	25%

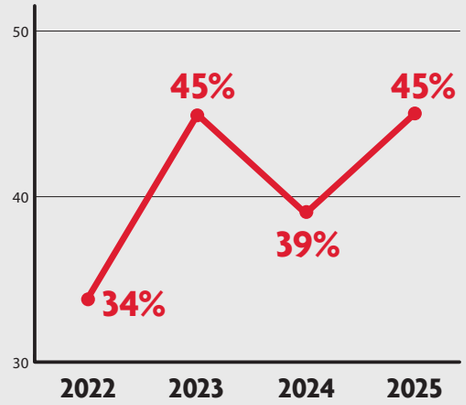
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Returnless refunds increasingly promote brand support and charitable giving.

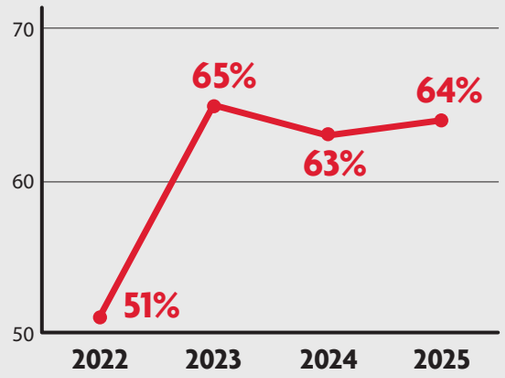
Leading consumer perceptions of returnless refund policies:



Shoppers who are encouraged to **donate unwanted items:**



Shoppers who are encouraged to **shop with the brand again:**

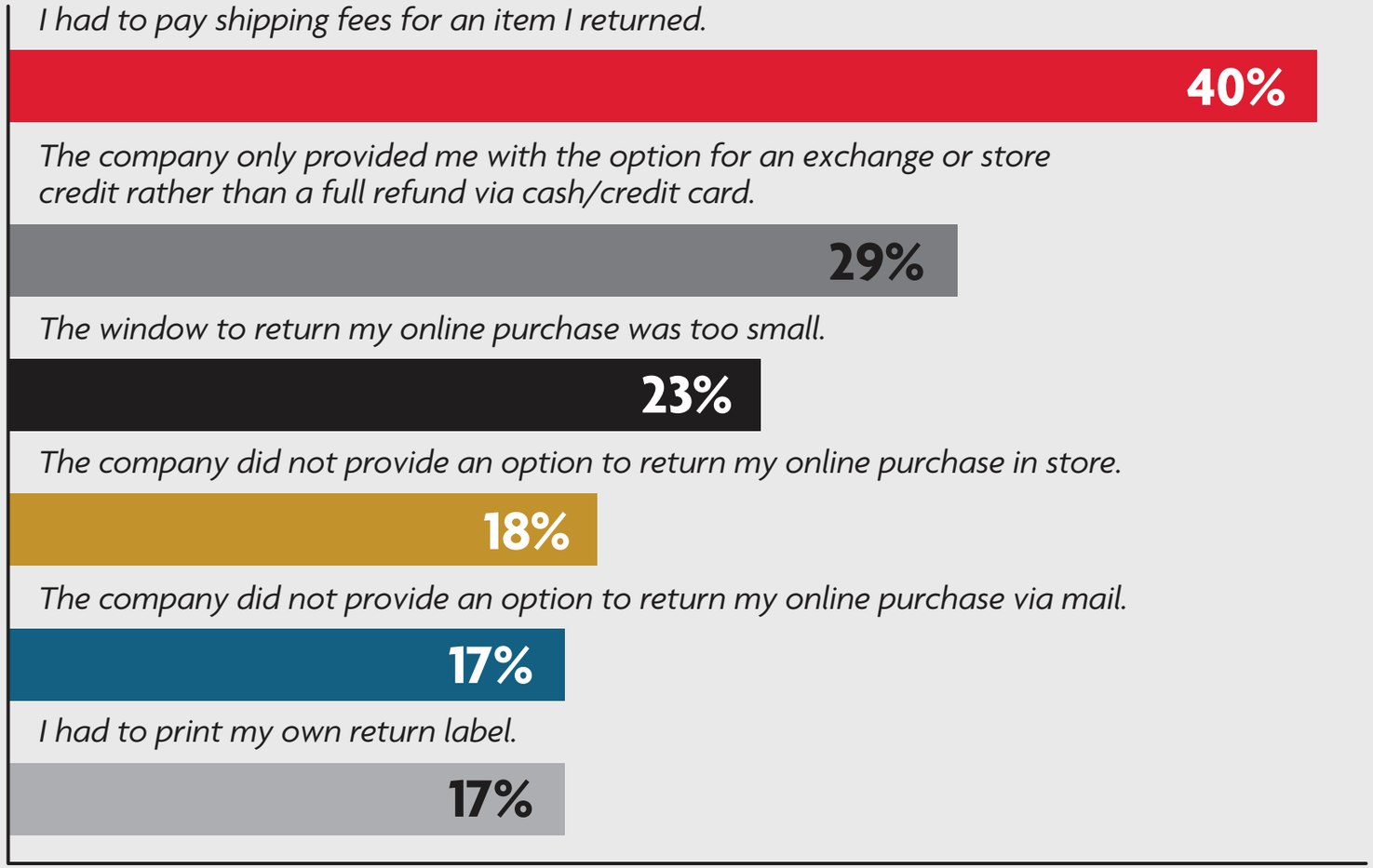


Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Failure to provide hassle-free returns puts customer retention at risk.

"Which of the following experiences have prevented you from continuing to shop with a company?"





Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

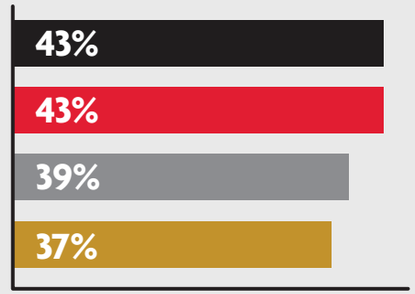
Younger shoppers are more likely to let returns-related hurdles affect future shopping decisions.

"Specifically related to returning online orders, which of the following experiences have prevented you from continuing to shop with a company?"

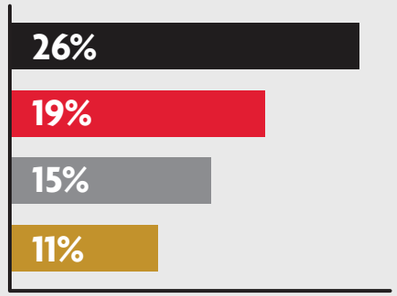
AGE GROUPS:

18-29 30-44 45-60 >60

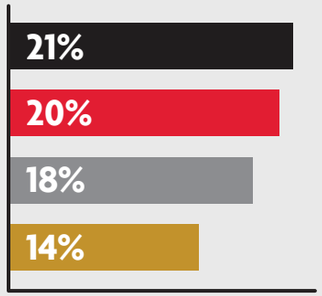
I **had to pay shipping fees** for an item I returned.



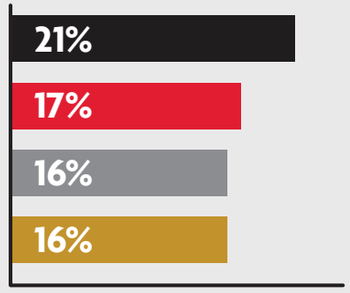
I had to **print my own return label.**



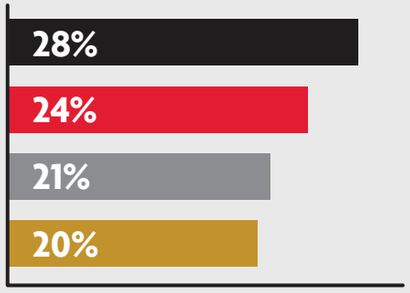
The company **did not** provide an option to **return my online purchase in-store.**



The company **did not** provide an option to **return my online purchase via mail.**



The **window to return** my purchase was **too small.**



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

PACKAGING



PACKAGING:
KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Perceived value and savings bring customers back to brands.
- A premium unboxing experience drives positive brand sentiment.
- Online shoppers place value on the protection boxes provide.

